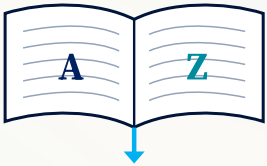
POCKET EDITION · 2026

The Manager's

AI Dictionary

14 words, decoded



Plain-English definitions, an **everyday analogy** and **why a manager should care**, for every AI word your team throws at you.

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compiled by AI Coach John · PROITBRIDGE · save for your next AI meeting

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What this is, and *why the words matter*

AI vendors, engineers and board decks use these 14 words every day. Each entry gives you a plain definition, an analogy and the question it should make you ask.

jargon */ˈdʒɑːɡən/* ***n.***

1. Words that make smart people stop asking questions.

'The deck was 40% jargon.'

Why you care: you can't govern a blur.

→ *See also: every AI vendor pitch*

headword
how to say it
plain definition
used in a sentence
why a manager cares
related words

Question it
Spot when a pitch is vague.

Budget it
Know what drives the cost.

Govern it
Set rules your team can follow.

Entries run A–Z. Use the thumb tabs on the edge to jump to a letter.

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agent */ˈeɪ.dʒənt/* ***n.***

1. An AI system that works toward a goal in steps: it plans, uses tools (email, search, your apps) and checks its progress.

> **e.g.** *'The agent found three suppliers and drafted the quotes.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A capable assistant with a ***to-do list and a set of keys***.

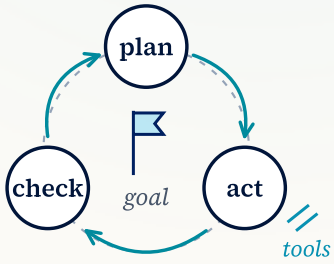


fig. 1 — plan, act, check

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Agents act, not just answer. Decide what they may touch and which steps need a human sign-off.

→ See also: ***LLM***, ***guardrails***, ***MCP***

context window /ˈkɒn.tekst ˈwɪn.dəʊ/ *n.*

1. How much text an AI model can "see" at once: your question, the files you paste and the chat so far.

> **e.g.** *'The contract was longer than the context window.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

The size of the desk.
Pages that don't fit fall on the floor.

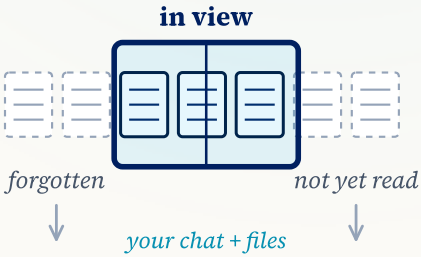


fig. 2 — what fits on the desk

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Long chats and huge files get partly forgotten. Split big jobs and start fresh threads.

→ See also: ***token***, ***RAG***

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embedding /ɪm'bed.ɪŋ/ *n.*

1. A list of numbers that captures what a piece of text *means*, so software can find text with similar meaning.

> **e.g.** *'Search found "refund" when we typed "money back".'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

Map coordinates for meaning: similar ideas sit close together.

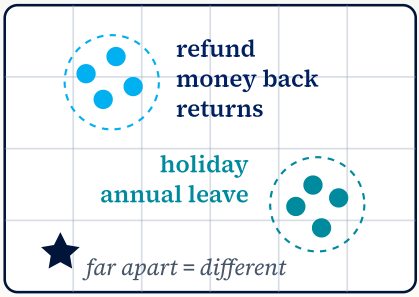


fig. 3 — a map of meaning

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Embeddings power smart search over your documents. Messy documents still give messy results.

→ See also: ***RAG***, ***token***

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eval /ɪ'væl/ *n.*

SHORT FOR *EVALUATION*

1. A repeatable test that scores AI answers against examples of good answers, run before and after every change.

> **e.g.** *'The new model failed our eval on VAT questions.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A driving test before you hand over the car keys.



fig. 4 — a test sheet (example)

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Ask every vendor and team: "How do we know it works, and how will we know when it breaks?"

→ See also: ***hallucination***, ***guardrails***

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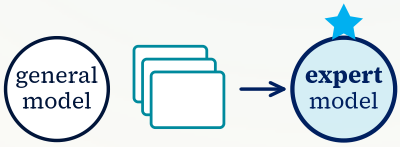
fine-tuning /faɪn'tjuːnɪŋ/ *n.*

1. Training an existing model further on your own examples so it learns a style, format or narrow task.

> **e.g.** *'We fine-tuned a small model to tag support tickets.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

Sending a smart generalist on ***a specialist course***.



same brain, extra course

fig. 5 — general to specialist

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Costly and slow to change. Try clear prompts and RAG first; fine-tune when those plateau.

→ See also: ***RAG***, ***prompt***

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guardrails /ˈgɑːd.reɪlz/ *n. pl.*

1. Rules and checks around an AI system that block unsafe, off-topic or private content going in or out.

> **e.g.** *'The guardrail stopped the bot sharing a customer's address.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

Bumpers in a bowling lane: the ball still rolls, it just can't end up in the gutter.

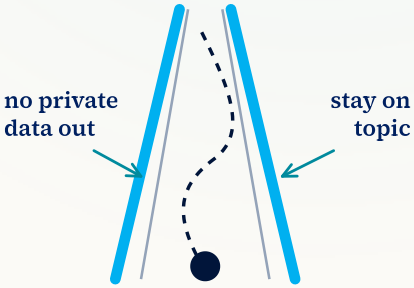


fig. 6 — the lane bumpers

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Guardrails turn your AI policy into software. Ask what gets blocked, logged and escalated.

→ See also: ***agent***, ***eval***

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hallucination /hə˧ˌluːsɪˈneɪ˧ʃən/ *n.*

1. When an AI states something false with full confidence: a made-up fact, number, quote or source.

> **e.g.** *'It cited a refund policy that doesn't exist.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A keen new hire who would ***rather guess than say "I don't know"***.



fig. 7 — confident, and wrong

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Fluent is not the same as true. Customer-facing answers and numbers need a source or a human check.

→ See also: ***RAG***, ***eval***

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LLM /ˌel.el'em/ *n.*

ABBR. *LARGE LANGUAGE MODEL*

1. The engine behind ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini: a model trained on huge amounts of text to predict the next word.

> **e.g.** *'Which LLM does this tool run on?'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

Autocomplete that has read a library.

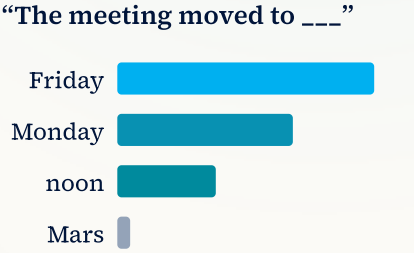


fig. 8 — guessing the next word

WHY A MANAGER CARES

It predicts plausible text, not checked truth. Great for drafts; add checks for facts.

→ See also: ***token***, ***hallucination***

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MCP /ˌem.siːˈpiː/ *n.*

ABBR. *Model Context Protocol*

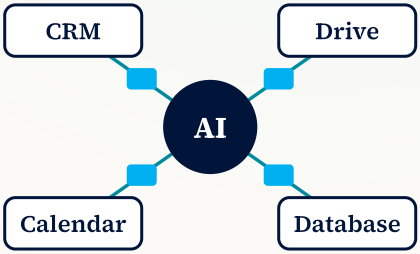
1. An open standard that lets AI assistants plug into tools and data (CRM, drive, calendar) in one common way.

> **e.g.** *'The vendor ships an MCP connector for our CRM.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A USB-C port for AI: one plug shape, many devices.

Origin: open standard released by Anthropic, Nov 2024.



one plug shape: MCP

fig. 9 — one plug, many tools

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Faster integrations, but every connection is access. Approve which tools get plugged in.

→ See also: ***agent***, ***guardrails***

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multimodal /ˌmʌl.tiˈməʊ.dəl/ *adj.*

1. Able to work with more than text: images, audio, video, charts and scanned documents.

> **e.g.** *'Snap the whiteboard and the model writes up the notes.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A colleague who can ***read, look at a photo and listen to a call.***

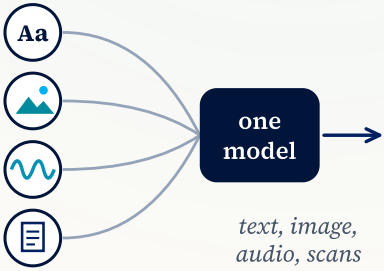


fig. 10 — many inputs, one model

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Unlocks work stuck in screenshots, PDFs and recordings. The same data rules apply to images.

→ See also: ***LLM***, ***embedding***

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prompt /prɒmpt/ *n. & v.*

1. The instruction and material you give an AI. The answer is only as good as the brief.

> **e.g.** *'Add the audience and the format to your prompt.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A brief to a smart contractor on day one: ***they know a lot, but nothing about you.***

BRIEF	
Role	sales coach
Context	new B2B reps
Task	5 call openers
Format	bullet list
Check	flag guesses

fig. 11 — a good brief (example)

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Better briefs beat better tools. Teach teams: role, context, task, format, check.

→ See also: ***context window***, ***temperature***

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RAG /ræg/ *n.*

ABBR. *RETRIEVAL-AUGMENTED GENERATION*

1. A set-up where the AI first searches your own documents, then answers from what it found, with sources.

> **e.g.** *'The HR assistant uses RAG over our policy handbook.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

An open-book exam instead of answering from memory.

Origin: Lewis et al., Facebook AI Research, 2020.

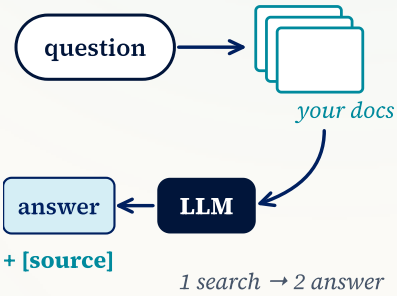


fig. 12 — search, then answer

WHY A MANAGER CARES

The usual way to make AI answer about YOUR business. Out-of-date documents give out-of-date answers.

→ See also: ***embedding***, ***hallucination***

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temperature /ˈtem.prə.tʃər/ *n.*

1. A setting that controls how predictable or varied an AI's wording is. Low is consistent; high is more creative.

> **e.g.** *'Keep the temperature low for contract summaries.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A dial between ***your accountant and your brainstorm partner***.



fig. 13 — the creativity dial

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Low for facts, policy and data; higher for ideas and copy. Ask what your tools are set to.

→ See also: ***hallucination***, ***prompt***

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token /ˈtəʊ.kən/ *n.*

1. A small chunk of text, often a word or part of one. AI reads, writes and bills in tokens.

> **e.g.** *'The pilot used far more tokens than we budgeted.'*

= EVERYDAY ANALOGY

A taxi meter that ticks per word piece, in and out.

unbelievable

un | believ | able

= 3 tokens

split varies by model

fig. 14 — one word, three tokens

WHY A MANAGER CARES

Tokens drive cost and limits. Long documents and wordy answers cost more.

→ See also: ***context window***, ***LLM***


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Index: *all 14 words on one page*

agent	AI that plans and takes actions
context window	how much it can read at once
embedding	numbers that capture meaning
eval	a repeatable quality test
fine-tuning	extra training on your examples
guardrails	rules that block bad in/out
hallucination	confident, made-up answers
LLM	the next-word engine
MCP	standard plug for tools and data
multimodal	text, images, audio, scans
prompt	your brief to the AI
RAG	search your docs, then answer
temperature	the precise-to-creative dial
token	word pieces you pay for

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